

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Electrotherapy for Treatment of Facial Nerve Paralysis (Bell's Palsy)

160.15

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

160.15

Manual Section Title

Electrotherapy for Treatment of Facial Nerve Paralysis (Bell's Palsy)

Version Number**Effective Date of this Version**

This is a longstanding national coverage determination. The effective date of this version has not been posted.

Description Information

Benefit Category

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

Electrotherapy for the treatment of facial nerve paralysis is the application of electrical stimulation to affected facial muscles to provide muscle innervation with the intention of preventing muscle degeneration. A device that generates an electrical current with controlled frequency, intensity, wave form and type (galvanic or faradic) is used in

combination with a pad electrode and a hand applicator electrode to provide electrical stimulation.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

Electrotherapy for the treatment of facial nerve paralysis, commonly known as Bell's Palsy, is not covered under Medicare because its clinical effectiveness has not been established.

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Electrotherapy for Treatment of Facial Nerve Paralysis (Bell's Palsy)	1	01/01/1966 - N/A	You are here